

REMOTELY PILOTED AIRCRAFT PILOT UTILIZATION FIELD (18XX)

Introduction (Established 30 Apr 10)

The Remotely Piloted Aircraft Pilot (RPA Pilot) Utilization Field encompasses all functions performed by rated RPA pilot officers to conduct or directly support RPA flying operations, including combat, combat support, and training missions. Inherently included are supervisory and staff functions such as inspection, contingency planning, and policy formulation.

Specific instruction on use of certain AFSCs:

Identify RPA pilots with 18XX specialties appropriate to the type of missions and weapon system involved. Use the following prefixes to identify additional rated qualifications and experience, and unit manpower document positions that require these capabilities:

- A Operational Warfare Instructor
- B Squadron Operations/Operations Support
- C Commander
- E Electronic Warfare
- F Aircraft Systems Flight Evaluation
- G Automated Systems Program Designer
- K Instructor for weapon system designated by AFSC
- Q Standardization or Flight Examiner for weapon system designated by AFSC
- S Safety
- T Formal Training Instructor
- U Information Operations
- W Weapons and Tactics Instructor
- Y Analytical Studies

Identify RPA pilots serving as instructor RPA pilots in undergraduate training and formal training units (FTU) with a T prefix. Do not award a T prefix to instructor remote pilots in operational units. Prefix K identifies these instructors and authorizations.

Identify requirements for staff officers above wing level with a staff AFSC (18X4). Award individuals possessing a qualified AFSC (18X3) or a staff AFSC (18X4) upon assignment to a position so identified.

Qualification level 3 designates an RPA pilot qualified as an aircraft commander in the assigned specialty or credit. Level 1 identifies rated remote pilots at the entry level for their specialty.

Current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service according to AFI 11-402, *Aviation and Parachutist Service, Aeronautical Ratings and Badges*, are mandatory for award and retention of RPA pilot AFSCs. See AFMAN 36-2100, *Military Utilization & Classification*, for policy on retention or withdrawal of rated AFSCs for personnel disqualified from aviation service or placed in an inactive status.

AFSC 18A4*, Staff
 AFSC 18A3*, Qualified
 AFSC 18A1*, Entry/Student

ATTACK REMOTELY PILOTED AIRCRAFT PILOT (Changed 31 Oct 12, Effective 27 Aug 12)

1. Specialty Summary. Operates specialized mission aircraft and commands flight crews to accomplish reconnaissance, surveillance, attack, combat, training, and other missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220100.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Supervises mission planning, equipment configuration, and crew briefing. Ensures ground station and aircraft are preflighted, inspected, loaded, and equipped for mission.

2.2. Operates aircraft and commands crew. Operates aircraft controls and equipment. Performs, supervises, or directs navigation, surveillance, reconnaissance, and weapons employment operations.

2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.

2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.

3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.

3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:

3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Undergraduate Remotely Piloted Aircraft Training (URT) or possess an aeronautical rating of Pilot or Navigator/Combat Systems Officer (CSO).

3.3.2. For award of AFSC 18A3X, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft.

3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSC 18A3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.

3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:

3.5.1. For award and retention of this AFSC:

3.5.1.1. Qualification for air vehicle operator duty according to AFI 48-123, *Medical Examinations and Standards*.

3.5.1.2. Current aeronautical rating and no permanent disqualification for aviation service as RPA Pilot.

3.5.2. For award of AFSC 18A3X, certification of aircraft commander qualification by appropriate operations authority.

3.5.3. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs, 18AXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
A	MQ-1
B	MQ-9
U	Air Liaison Officer (ALO)
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 18E4*, Staff
 AFSC 18E3*, Qualified
 AFSC 18E1*, Entry/Student

EXPERIMENTAL TEST REMOTELY PILOTED AIRCRAFT PILOT (Changed 30 Apr17)

1. Specialty Summary. Plans, conducts, directs, and reports on flight test programs associated with the design, development, and modification of remotely piloted aircraft, aerospace vehicles, flight simulators, and related systems. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220200.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

- 2.1. Plans and conducts flight test activities. Formulates test procedures and conducts tests to evaluate structural integrity, performance, handling characteristics, reliability, and suitability of aircraft and systems.
- 2.2. Manages research, test and evaluation projects, and programs. Integrates test objectives, organizes and directs test forces, and supervises flight operations.
- 2.3. Identifies design and operational deficiencies and recommends improvements. Prepares technical reports and recommendations for design improvements.
- 2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

- 3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of aircraft performance and handling fundamentals, operational employment concepts, and flight test procedures.
- 3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, or engineering is mandatory.
- 3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Undergraduate Remotely Piloted Aircraft Training (URT) or possess an aeronautical rating of Pilot or Navigator/Combat Systems Officer (CSO).
 - 3.3.2. For award of AFSC 18E3X, completion of the Air Force Test Pilot School, Experimental Test Pilot Course, or equivalent US Navy or foreign test pilot school is mandatory.
- 3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSC 18E3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.
- 3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.5.1. For award and retention of this AFSC:
 - 3.5.1.1. Current aeronautical rating and qualification for aviation service as RPA pilot.
 - 3.5.1.2. Current aeronautical rating and no permanent disqualification for aviation service as RPA Pilot.
 - 3.5.2. For award of AFSC 18E3X, certification of aircraft commander qualification by appropriate operations authority.
 - 3.5.3. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs, 18EXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
A	Attack
B	Reconnaissance
C	Special Operations
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 18G4, Staff
AFSC 18G3, Qualified

GENERALIST REMOTELY PILOTED AIRCRAFT PILOT
(Changed 30 Apr 12)

1. Specialty Summary. Develops plans and policies, monitors and evaluates operations, coordinates staff activities, and advises commanders. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220100.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

Monitors, evaluates, and directs flying operations and training programs. Develops requirements for equipment and training. Prepares and coordinates budgets. Analyzes rated manpower requirements and formulates personnel policies. Prepares, coordinates, and disseminates policy directives and implementing instructions. Develops contingency plans.

3. Specialty Qualifications. For entry into this specialty, prior qualification in any remote pilot AFSC (18X3) is mandatory.

3.1. Knowledge. Not used.

3.2. Education. Not used.

3.3. Training. Not used.

3.4. Experience. Not used.

3.5. Other:

3.5.1. For award and retention of this AFSC, current aeronautical rating and no permanent disqualification for aviation service as RPA Pilot.

3.5.2. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs 18GX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*, is mandatory.

NOTE: These AFSCs are only authorized to identify nonflying positions where designation of a specific remote pilot AFSC is not feasible.

AFSC 18R4*, Staff
 AFSC 18R3*, Qualified
 AFSC 18R1*, Entry/Student

RECONNAISSANCE REMOTELY PILOTED AIRCRAFT PILOT (Changed 30 Apr 12)

1. Specialty Summary. Operates specialized mission aircraft and commands flight crews to accomplish reconnaissance, surveillance, combat, training, and other missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220100.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Supervises mission planning, equipment configuration, and crew briefing. Ensures ground station and aircraft are preflighted, inspected, loaded, and equipped for mission.

2.2. Operates aircraft and commands crew. Operates aircraft controls and equipment. Performs, supervises, or directs navigation, surveillance, reconnaissance, and weapons employment operations.

2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.

2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.

3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.

3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:

3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Undergraduate Remotely Piloted Aircraft Training (URT) or possess an aeronautical rating of Pilot or Navigator/Combat Systems Officer (CSO).

3.3.2. For award of AFSC 18R3X, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft.

3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSC 18R3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.

3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:

3.5.1. For award and retention of this AFSC:

3.5.1.1. Qualification for air vehicle operator duty according to AFI 48-123, *Medical Examinations and Standards*.

3.5.1.2. Current aeronautical rating and no permanent disqualification for aviation service as RPA Pilot.

3.5.2. For award of AFSC 18R3X, certification of aircraft commander qualification by appropriate operations authority.

3.5.3. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs 18RXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
C	RQ-4
E	RQ-170
Y	General
Z	Other

AFSC 18S4*, Staff
 AFSC 18S3*, Qualified
 AFSC 18S1*, Entry/Student

SPECIAL OPERATIONS REMOTELY PILOTED AIRCRAFT PILOT (Changed 30 Apr 12)

1. Specialty Summary. Operates specialized mission aircraft and commands flight crews to accomplish special operations, combat, training, and other missions. Related DoD Occupational Group: 220100.

2. Duties and Responsibilities:

- 2.1. Plans and prepares for mission. Reviews mission tasking, intelligence, and weather information. Supervises mission planning, equipment configuration, and crew briefing. Ensures ground station and aircraft are preflighted, inspected, loaded, and equipped for mission.
- 2.2. Operates aircraft and commands crew. Operates aircraft controls and equipment. Performs, supervises, or directs navigation, surveillance, reconnaissance, and weapons employment operations.
- 2.3. Conducts or supervises training of crewmembers. Ensures operational readiness of crew by conducting or supervising mission specific training.
- 2.4. Develops plans and policies, monitors operations, and advises commanders. Assists commanders and performs staff functions related to this specialty.

3. Specialty Qualifications:

- 3.1. Knowledge. Knowledge is mandatory of theory of flight, air navigation, meteorology, flying directives, aircraft operating procedures, and mission tactics.
- 3.2. Education. For entry into this specialty, an undergraduate degree specializing in physical sciences, mathematics, administration, or management is desirable.
- 3.3. Training. The following training is mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.3.1. For entry into this specialty, completion of Air Force Undergraduate Remotely Piloted Aircraft Training (URT) or possess an aeronautical rating of Pilot or Navigator/Combat Systems Officer (CSO).
 - 3.3.2. For award of AFSC 18S3X, completion of transition and operational training in the suffix specific aircraft.
- 3.4. Experience. For upgrade to AFSC 18S3X, unit commander determines proficiency based on performance, experience, and completion of minimum training requirements.
- 3.5. Other. The following are mandatory as indicated:
 - 3.5.1. For award and retention of this AFSC:
 - 3.5.1.1. Qualification for air vehicle operator duty according to AFI 48-123, *Medical Examinations and Standards*.
 - 3.5.1.2. Current aeronautical rating and no permanent disqualification for aviation service as RPA Pilot.
 - 3.5.2. For award of AFSC 18S3X, certification of aircraft commander qualification by appropriate operations authority.
 - 3.5.3. Specialty requires routine access to Tier 5 (T5) information, systems or similar classified environments. For award and retention of AFSCs, 18SXX, completion of a current T5 Investigation IAW DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16-1405, *Air Force Personnel Security Program*.

NOTE: Award of the entry level without a completed T5 Investigation is authorized provided an interim Top Secret security clearance has been granted according to DoDM 5200.02_AFMAN 16 -1405.

4. *Specialty Shredouts:

<i>Suffix</i>	<i>Portion of AFS to Which Related</i>
A	MQ-1
B	MQ-9
U	Air Liaison Officer (ALO)
Y	General
Z	Other